



Baking the perfect pizza

Physicists found that the reason brick ovens produce better pizzas is the slow rate of heat transfer. <https://digit.in/Aug18-86-1>



Devastating DNA test

What happens when a DNA test given to you as a gift changes everything about who you thought you were? <https://digit.in/Aug18-86-2>

PROLOGUE

"The tide is turning

Oh, oh, oh, the tide is turning",

Avisa hummed as she entered the office building. Always in love with Waters, this song struck a special chord with her given the times. The worst of times were behind them, the best were about to start; everybody had learned from their foolishness, the age of wisdom had begun. Wiping the sweat of her face, she stopped for a moment to read the quote grandly displayed at the entrance,

Thousands have lived without love,

Not one without water

– W. H Auden.

A succinct summary of the past 10 years, thought Avisa. The entire country learned this truth the hard way.

CHAPTER 1

The first warning bells were heard 12 years ago, and immediately ignored, in 2018 when a report was presented that the nation's capital, Delhi, amongst several other metro cities could run out of water by 2020. Of course this was followed by the usual brouhaha, public outrage recorded on social media, panel discussions and appropriate politician responses. But in terms of concrete action; zero, zip, nada. Soon the people forgot about it and moved on to more pressing issues about elections and celebrity news.

There were a few beacons, lighthouses working tirelessly to show the light to a wilfully blind audience. Several NGO's, social activists, scientists would regularly talk about water scarcity and wilful wastage. Some enterprising individuals would turn entrepreneur recognising a need and a potential demand for a product and service like rainwater harvesting. In this mix came Avisa.

The only daughter of an environmental activist and a passionate businesswoman, social entrepreneurship became the natural course for her. One of the few people to understand the urgency of the situation, her historic venture, Kumuda, was born in the raging summers of 2021. Avisa knew she stood at the beginning of a momentous period. If she succeeded, she could be hailed as the saviour of her times. The only question plaguing her – could she do it in time?

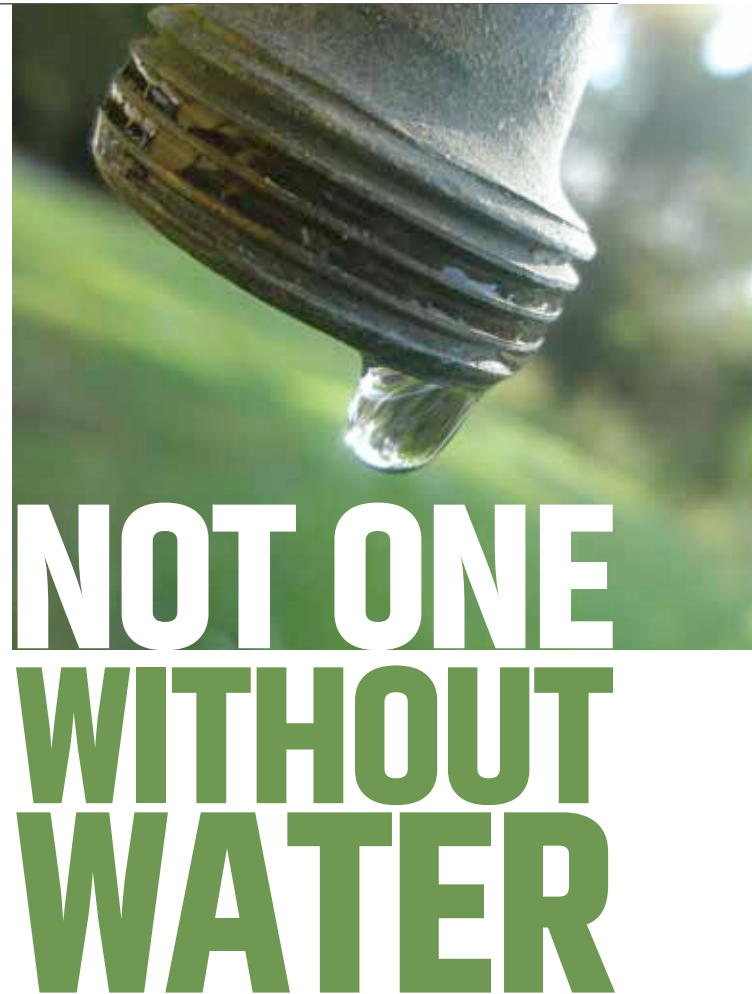
CHAPTER 2

"The road to hell or in this case, bankruptcy, is paved with good intentions", intoned Robin in his most serious voice.

"With great risk comes great reward", countered Avisa.

She waited patiently for him to make another one of his "the world wants to go to hell and we should let it" arguments. A popular cynic and a leading chemical scientist, he was the first and most vital element in her roadmap.

"And pray tell me what is the reward? A pat on the back for 'good efforts and a great show pal' followed by the inevitable condescending question, 'but is this really necessary?' These are the people we are doing it for? I have been at this game when you were learning about the environment and nothing's



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changed. I like you Avisa. And I respect you. So I will give you free and valuable advice – do not bother. They are happy in their ignorance and rejoice in their daily fodder of garbage."

Smiling on the inside, Avisa knew she could be patient with Robin because she knew his secret – he was a closeted idealist. He had seen his idealism burned and be dismissed as a fool's errand. And in his impassioned speech, she had seen



Groundbreaking technology cannot be created from a place of comfort. To create something unique, one has to take a leap of faith